SENIORS HOUSING & LONG-TERM CARE · QUARTERLY BRIEF

MARKET TRENDS / APRIL 2026

As active brokers and capital facilitators, we regularly engage with investors, operators, and lenders to stay current on the seniors housing and long-term care market. This brief highlights twelve signals drawn from recent conversations with industry stakeholders of all types.

01 **Competitive marketing hiring.** Some larger operators are adopting competitive marketing structures by hiring multiple marketing directors on a trial basis and evaluating performance based on monthly move-ins, using this approach to identify and retain the strongest candidates before making long-term hires.

02 **Referral agencies going full-service.** Referral and placement agencies are expanding beyond move-in referrals to offer full-service geriatric care management and relocation support, including downsizing, moving logistics, and storage coordination.

03 **LTC insurance under scrutiny.** Communities with higher concentrations of long-term care insurance residents are facing increased underwriting scrutiny. While this cohort remains reliable today, driven by aggressive policy sales to baby boomers decades ago, insurers have since pulled back after mispricing the product. As this generation phases out, LTC insurance is expected to become a less dependable payor source.

04 **Masonic & fraternal consolidation.** Freemason/Masonic and fraternal organizations are contacting one another about moving residents into sister communities as some consider closing. While these groups share affiliations across state lines, they are sovereign and operate independently, and not all are on equal financial footing.

05 **Operators building their own tech.** Recent developments in AI and coding have begun empowering more tech-savvy operators to build out their own sales/lead funneling and light operations systems, including staff task tracking, internal messaging, and scheduling software.

06 **Referral platform consolidation.** The acquisition of Seniorly by CareScout (Genworth Financial) has pushed other referral platforms to explore adjacent verticals, including payer alignment and deeper integration with healthcare providers and discharge networks, in an effort to move upstream and better control demand flow.

07 **Rural health transformation funding.** This continues to be viewed favorably in certain states for supporting reimbursement and care delivery across senior care settings. However, implementation and impact vary widely, as funds are allocated at the state level, resulting in highly differentiated priorities and outcomes across markets.

08 **Tribal-land regulatory complexity.** A small subset of senior housing communities located on Tribal lands are facing regulatory complexity in more oversight-heavy states, where tensions between tribal sovereignty and state Department of Health requirements create operational challenges and uncertainty around compliance for operators, buyers, and lenders.

09 **Resident councils as a tool.** More senior housing communities are establishing resident councils as a proactive way to give residents a structured voice, address concerns internally, and mitigate negative public reviews (or state complaints) by resolving issues before they escalate.

10 **Transparent rent-increase narratives.** Independently owned senior communities are becoming far more transparent in how they justify rent increases, replacing generic renewal notices with clear, visual breakdowns of rising costs across wages, utilities, insurance, and food. By putting real P&L dynamics in front of families, they see far less pushback, as increases are understood as a function of sustainability rather than greed.

11 **Third-party memory-care accreditation.** Operators are increasingly pursuing a range of third-party dementia training programs and staff accreditations, strengthening market-facing brand positioning while providing caregivers with more standardized, recognized credentials.

12 **Workforce housing conversions.** Senior communities that are functionally obsolete or closed are becoming viable candidates for workforce housing funding, as states continue to support development through grants, tax credits, and subsidized financing.

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